

THE CASE OF THE MISSING PENDRIVE

Story Bible — Final Version

The Real Story (organizers only — never told to teams outright)

One thief. One almost-thief. One collision. After hours, when the campus should've been empty.

Why a pendrive, of all things

CoHo keeps its banking details — the club's account logins, transaction records, everything the Treasurer needs for tomorrow's audit — on a single pendrive. It's kept locked inside the faculty coordinator's office in **SCB**, since that's the one place on campus with real security for club records. Nobody without a key gets in. Two people needed it that night. Only one of them actually could get in.

SCB itself is off-limits for the hunt — restricted, never a clue site. Teams never go there. It only matters as the place the pendrive started, mentioned once in the opening card as flavor.

The Java Lead — his night

He's got a gambling problem nobody on campus knows about. That night, after losing big on one last bet, he decided the only way out was to get into CoHo's account before the audit and move enough to cover it — quietly, and put it back before anyone checked.

He's senior enough in the club to know where the coordinator keeps a spare key to the SCB office, tucked in a drawer nobody else thinks to check. Getting into the room isn't the hard part — getting onto campus after hours is. Gates were locked, no scan-in this late. He snuck in near **Main Gate**, where the fence sags just enough — tore his sleeve doing it, didn't notice till later.

Kept to the shadows through **Student Parking**, crossed the top walkway along **Ground**, stepped in a puddle he didn't check — all just to reach SCB unseen.

Let himself into the office with the spare key, found the pendrive exactly where it's always kept, wrapped it in the nearest cloth he could grab, and slipped back out. Now he's retracing his steps, pendrive tucked under one arm, cutting back along the outer wall toward **Garden**, aiming to get back through **Main Gate** the way he came.

The Event Coordinator — her night

She's been eyeing a designer bag for months. Screenshotted the listing to her group chat more times than she'd admit. She already "borrowed" a little from the decoration budget to almost afford it — and the audit tomorrow would catch it instantly.

She doesn't have SCB access. Her plan was to catch the coordinator still around after hours and talk her way into "checking something" on the records — a bad plan, but the only one she had once the audit date moved up. She'd been waiting near the **Placement Banner by MG**, close to SCB, phone brightness turned all the way down to save battery, scrolling the same listing for the hundredth time, watching for anyone with keys.

Nobody came. Eventually she gives up on catching someone and decides to try SCB's door herself, on the off chance it's unlocked — heading the same direction he's already coming from, toward **Garden**, straight into his path without either of them knowing it.

The Clash — Garden, right by the Canteen

Same path. Same second. Complete dark. He's coming from SCB, pendrive under one arm, cutting through Garden toward Main Gate. She's coming from the Placement Banner, heading the opposite way down the same path, aiming for SCB. Neither expected anyone else on campus at all — let alone someone coming from the exact place either of them cared about. They collide head-on, right where Garden meets the Canteen's outer wall.

The pendrive comes loose — not thrown, not kicked on purpose, just knocked out of a bad one-armed grip. It hits the ground near the Canteen's edge. Neither of them looks down. Both are too busy panicking about the stranger in front of them.

After the clash — two directions

He bolts back the way he snuck in — Garden → Ground (top walkway) → Student Parking → over the sagging fence → **Main Gate, gone**. Doesn't realize his arms are empty until he's already off campus.

She bolts the opposite way — fast-food strip → Badminton Court → **Placement Banner by MV/CV**, where she finally stops, hands on her knees, and only then realizes she never actually got her hands on the pendrive at all.

The pendrive itself, now unwrapped and kicked loose in the scramble, skids off the doorstep and onto the top walkway — which slopes gently down toward Ground — and just keeps rolling, unassisted, the whole corridor length, coming to rest **backstage at Empty Stage**, half-covered by whatever CoHo has stored back there.

Neither thief knows this. Neither of them will ever bring it up again.

Tone

Comedy, not crime drama. A gambler and a shopaholic, colliding by pure bad luck, both fleeing something that was never actually dangerous. Every clue reads like a cop-dispatch call-out — timestamped, deadpan — but what's underneath is inherently silly. Teams should laugh at what they're investigating, not feel spooked by it.

Geography

His route (Track B's territory): Main Gate → Student Parking → Ground (top walkway) → past SCB (restricted, no clue site) → back the same way, through Garden, toward Main Gate again.

Her route (Track A's territory): Placement Banner (MG side) → Garden, heading toward SCB (restricted, no clue site) → after the clash, fast-food strip → Badminton Court → Placement Banner (MV/CV side).

Shared: Garden, right at the Canteen's edge (the clash site), and Empty Stage (the finale — where the pendrive actually ended up, purely by accident).

Restricted, never used for clues: SCB, MG building, MV, CV, Faculty Parking, MECH — mentioned only as scenery someone might walk past, never as a clue site.

Track Split

Track A — "Girl, Where's My Bag" follows the Event Coordinator: her wait, her nerve, her run deeper into campus, ending empty-handed.

Track B — "The Losing Streak" follows the Java Lead: his gambling trail, his break-in, his run for the exit, also ending empty-handed. Coding-flavored puzzles fit his character.

Neither track needs the other's evidence to reach the finale. The connection only becomes obvious once both groups are standing at Empty Stage.

Physical Details Available for Clues

- **Torn sleeve** at Main Gate — a fabric scrap, from climbing the sagging fence
- **Mud / puddle print** at Student Parking — a footprint, from cutting across in the dark
- **Cloth wrapping** — came loose right at the clash site (Garden/Canteen edge), separate from the pendrive itself, findable on its own
- **Drained phone battery** at Placement Banner (MG side) — hers, from scrolling all night while she waited
- **Motion-sensor light** she avoided near the fast-food stand — shows she knows the campus well
- **Slope of the top walkway** — the physical reason the pendrive specifically ends up at Empty Stage and nowhere else

Naming the Culprit (bonus, optional)

Not required to win — reaching Empty Stage first (top 3 overall, either track) wins. Teams that gather enough clues can name their track's character for bonus points, using vague traits only, never a real name:

- **Track B hints:** mustache, always in white, jumpy, hangs around the sports block a lot
- **Track A hints:** always on her phone, something new and shiny, dressed up for no reason on a random Tuesday

Open Items

1. Confirm Empty Stage can physically handle all 32 teams converging for the finale.
2. Placement Banner is currently one merged zone in the Master Map's routing — if the MG-side and MV/CV-side banners need to function as two distinct stops, some team assignments will need adjusting.